



ST. PIUS X CATHOLIC HIGH SCHOOL · MODEL UN CONFERENCE 2026

CRISIS COMMITTEE

The Simpsons: Springfield in Crisis

Sector 7-G has failed. Every resident of Springfield is either a potential savior or a potential suspect.

Andrew Dinwiddie, Head Chair & Eli Lentz, Crisis Director

CRISIS/BG/2026

Background: nuclear power plant, Wikimedia Commons, CC BY-SA

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Letter from the Head Chair

Hello Esteemed Delegates,

It is my pleasure to welcome you to The Simpsons: Springfield in Crisis. My name is Andrew Dinwiddie, and I will serve as your Head Chair. In this committee, you will become the political leaders, business figures, public servants, celebrities, criminals, and ordinary residents responsible for guiding Springfield through one of the greatest disasters in its history.

Successful delegates will combine energetic debate with practical action. The committee will reward delegates who understand their character's relationships, resources, and motivations; introduce creative but workable solutions; and respond thoughtfully as the crisis develops. Humor is an important part of the committee, but jokes should support substantive debate rather than replace it.

Every character has a reason to care about Springfield's future, though they may strongly disagree about what that future should look like. Some will seek justice, some will seek power, and others may simply seek to survive. Delegates should cooperate when their interests overlap while remaining prepared for alliances to shift as new information emerges.

I cannot wait to see the stories, policies, and wonderfully chaotic plans you create. Welcome to Springfield.

Andrew Dinwiddie | Head Chair

Letter from the Crisis Director

Dear Delegates,

My name is Eli Lentz, and I am excited to serve as your Crisis Director for The Simpsons: Springfield in Crisis. Springfield is a town in which a routine city council meeting can become a riot, an alien sighting, a monorail disaster, or all three before lunch. You should therefore expect the situation facing the committee to change quickly.

Your decisions will shape the world beyond the committee room. Public directives will determine Springfield's official response, while private crisis notes will allow you to use your character's personal resources, relationships, and ambitions. Strong crisis actions will have a clear objective, identify the resources being used, explain how the plan will be carried out, and consider its possible consequences.

Delegates are encouraged to be bold, but actions must remain connected to the abilities of their characters and the world of The Simpsons. Springfield is exaggerated and absurd, but it still has institutions, money, public opinion, and consequences. A creative plan supported by preparation will be far more effective than an unexplained request for unlimited power.

Most importantly, have fun and help create a story that the entire committee can enjoy. I look forward to seeing whether you save Springfield, rule it, expose it, rebuild it—or somehow make everything worse.

Eli Lentz | Crisis Director

Introduction

It is 8:03 a.m. on an otherwise ordinary Monday in Springfield. Employees are arriving late to the Springfield Nuclear Power Plant, students are beginning another day at Springfield Elementary, and Mayor Joe Quimby is preparing to announce a new municipal beautification program. Without warning, every alarm inside Sector 7-G begins to sound.

Operators report a rapid loss of coolant in the plant's primary reactor. Emergency systems fail to activate. Seconds later, a powerful explosion shakes the facility, cuts electricity across Springfield, and sends a dark cloud into the sky. The blast damages the plant but does not immediately destroy the reactor. No one can determine whether a full meltdown has begun—or how much time remains before one becomes unavoidable.

The disaster quickly spreads beyond the plant. Springfield General Hospital loses power and begins relying on an aging emergency generator. Traffic lights stop functioning, trapping residents in gridlock as rumors of radiation spread. Looting begins at the Kwik-E-Mart. Springfield Elementary is ordered to shelter in place, although conflicting reports suggest the school may lie directly in the projected path of contamination.



Sector 7-G's alarms sound just after 8:03 a.m. Stand-in photo: a nuclear power plant. Wikimedia Commons CC BY-SA

The police department is overwhelmed by emergency calls, and Chief Wiggum cannot confirm whether the town has a functioning evacuation plan. At 8:26 a.m., the Springfield Nuclear Power Plant releases a short statement claiming that the situation is "completely contained and probably harmless." Minutes later, an anonymous employee sends Channel 6 documents suggesting that plant executives ignored years of safety violations. Kent Brockman announces that he will reveal the documents during a live emergency broadcast. Mr. Burns denies wrongdoing and claims the explosion may have been an act of sabotage.

The political situation is equally unstable. Mayor Quimby declares a municipal state of emergency, but critics argue that his close financial relationship with Mr. Burns creates a conflict of interest. The state governor has threatened to place Springfield under state control if local officials cannot restore order. Shelbyville offers emergency assistance, though Springfield residents question whether their longtime rival can be trusted. Meanwhile, an unidentified group has interrupted local radio frequencies with a message declaring that Springfield's corrupt government has reached its end.

Springfield has survived disasters before. The town has endured hurricanes, riots, environmental catastrophes, fraudulent infrastructure projects, and repeated attacks by Sideshow Bob. Its survival has often depended less upon competent government than upon the strange loyalty its residents possess toward one another. That loyalty will now face its greatest test.

The committee consists of Springfield's emergency leadership council: government officials, plant representatives, first responders, community leaders, experts, and influential residents. It begins approximately one hour after the initial explosion. Delegates must determine whether to evacuate Springfield, contain the damaged reactor, preserve essential services, investigate the cause of the explosion, and decide who can be trusted with emergency authority.

The crisis may be an accident caused by decades of negligence. It may be a deliberate act of sabotage. It may also be the opening move in a larger attempt to control Springfield. Until the truth is discovered, every member of the committee is both a potential savior and a potential suspect.

Political structure and emergency authority

Springfield is governed by Mayor Joe Quimby and a city council, but its public institutions are notoriously weak. Elections are frequently influenced by wealthy donors, sensational media coverage, and angry mobs. During emergencies, authority is divided among the mayor's office, the police department, the fire department, state officials, and whichever resident happens to possess the loudest megaphone.

The declaration of a state of emergency gives Mayor Quimby temporary authority to direct municipal agencies, close roads, requisition supplies, and issue evacuation orders. However, those powers depend upon cooperation from public employees and the population. The committee may choose to preserve Quimby's authority, restrict it, remove him, or establish an entirely new emergency government.

The Springfield Nuclear Power Plant

The Springfield Nuclear Power Plant is the town's largest employer and its most powerful private institution. It is owned by Charles Montgomery Burns and managed through a confusing hierarchy designed to protect senior leadership from blame. The plant supplies most of Springfield's electricity, meaning that shutting it down completely could leave the town without power for an extended period.

The facility has a long record of safety problems. Employees receive inconsistent training, hazardous waste has allegedly been stored improperly, and inspectors have sometimes disappeared from public view after meeting with Mr. Burns. Homer Simpson, the plant's Nuclear Safety Inspector for Sector 7-G, was assigned responsibilities far beyond his technical qualifications. Whether Homer caused the accident, witnessed it, or was deliberately positioned to take the blame remains unknown.

Public health and evacuation

Radiation cannot be managed like an ordinary fire or chemical spill. Residents closest to the plant may require immediate evacuation, medical screening, decontamination, and long-term monitoring. Springfield General Hospital has limited beds and supplies. Dr. Hibbert warns that panic could overwhelm the hospital even before radiation-related injuries become visible.

Evacuation presents its own dangers. Springfield possesses few major roads, and several are already blocked. Vulnerable residents—including hospital patients, retirement-home residents, and children—will require transportation. A poorly managed evacuation could expose more people to danger than a carefully controlled shelter-in-place order.

Media, rumors, and public opinion

Channel 6 is Springfield's primary source of breaking news. Kent Brockman can influence public behavior almost instantly, but he is also vulnerable to sensationalism and incomplete information. Radio, television, and telephone service remain unreliable following the explosion. In their absence, rumors are spreading that the town's water is poisoned, that mutants have escaped from the plant, and that Springfield will be permanently abandoned.

The committee must decide what information to release and who should deliver it. Concealing danger may prevent immediate panic but destroy public trust later. Releasing unverified information could cause riots, vigilante activity, or a disastrous rush toward the highways.

Springfield and Shelbyville

Springfield and Shelbyville have competed for generations. Shelbyville possesses emergency vehicles and hospital capacity that Springfield desperately needs. Its mayor has offered assistance in exchange for temporary authority over the regional response and access to Springfield's power infrastructure. Accepting the offer could save lives, but it could also make Springfield dependent upon its rival.

How Crisis Committee Works

If this is your first crisis committee, the pace and format will feel different from a General Assembly. This page covers the basics of how a session actually runs.

The flow of a session

Time in committee is spent either in formal debate, where delegates speak from a speaker's list on the general topic, or in caucus, where the committee narrows in on a specific problem. A delegate proposes a motion — most often to move into a moderated or unmoderated caucus — and the committee votes on it. The chair keeps time, recognizes speakers, and rules on procedure throughout.

Substantive work happens in two parallel tracks. In the open room, delegates debate and eventually vote on directives that represent Springfield's official response. Away from the open room, delegates submit private crisis notes describing what their individual characters are doing behind the scenes. Committee Powers, later in this guide, explains both in detail.

Motions you'll use most

Moderated caucus

The chair calls on delegates one at a time, for a set speaking time, on a specific sub-topic. Most substantive debate happens here.

Unmoderated caucus

Debate pauses and delegates leave their seats to negotiate directly, form blocs, and draft directives together.

Introduce a directive

Brings a drafted directive to a vote before the full committee.

Table debate

Sets the current topic aside so the committee can move to something more urgent.

Points

A point is a procedural question directed at the chair, and it does not require a second or a vote. A point of order flags a violation of procedure. A point of inquiry asks the chair a question about the rules or the situation. A point of personal privilege addresses a delegate's comfort, such as room temperature or audibility, and can be raised even while another delegate is speaking.

FIRST-TIMER TIP

You do not need to have every rule memorized before your first speech. Raise your placard, ask the chair if you are unsure of a procedure, and follow the lead of more experienced delegates around you. Chairs expect and plan for this.

Key Locations

Springfield is compact, which is part of the problem: the town's essential services sit close enough together that a single disaster at the plant threatens nearly everything else. The schematic below is not to scale and is meant only to orient delegates to how the crisis can move from one location to the next.

Springfield Nuclear Power Plant

Ground zero. Sector 7-G, Mr. Burns's office, and the damaged reactor.

Springfield River

Runs behind the plant. A possible route for coolant runoff or contamination.

Shelbyville border

Springfield's rival is minutes away and has offered aid, at a price.

Springfield General Hospital

Losing power. Dr. Hibbert is triaging patients on generator backup.

Town Hall

Mayor Quimby's base of operations and the seat of emergency authority.

Springfield Elementary

Sheltering in place. Possibly inside the contamination radius.

Springfield Police Dept.

Chief Wiggum's overwhelmed switchboard and holding cells.

Kwik-E-Mart

Looting has already begun. A flashpoint for public order.

Moe's Tavern

Where rumors move fastest and Fat Tony's network stays informed.

First Church of Springfield

Reverend Lovejoy's shelter and gathering point for residents.

Channel 6 Studios

Kent Brockman's broadcast booth. Whatever airs here becomes fact.

Timeline of the Crisis

The events below are confirmed as of the start of committee. Treat this timeline as a starting point, not a complete record — much of what happened before 8:03 a.m. is still unknown.

8:03 a.m.	Every alarm in Sector 7-G sounds without warning. Operators report a rapid loss of coolant.
8:04 a.m.	Emergency shutdown systems fail to activate. Plant supervisors cannot explain why.
8:09 a.m.	A powerful explosion strikes the reactor building. Power fails across most of Springfield.
8:15 a.m.	Springfield General switches to backup power. Traffic signals fail town-wide.
8:19 a.m.	Looting is reported at the Kwik-E-Mart. Springfield Elementary shelters in place.
8:26 a.m.	The plant calls the situation "completely contained and probably harmless."
8:31 a.m.	An anonymous employee sends Channel 6 documents alleging ignored safety violations.
8:37 a.m.	Quimby declares a state of emergency. Mr. Burns denies wrongdoing and suggests sabotage.
8:44 a.m.	The governor threatens state control if local officials cannot restore order.
8:50 a.m.	Shelbyville offers vehicles and hospital capacity in exchange for regional authority.
8:58 a.m.	An unidentified group interrupts local radio to declare Springfield's government finished.
9:03 a.m.	Springfield's emergency leadership council is convened. Committee begins here.

Questions to Consider

1. Should Springfield order a complete evacuation, a limited evacuation, or shelter residents in place?
2. Who should possess emergency authority, and what limits should be placed upon that authority?
3. How can the committee contain the reactor while protecting plant employees and first responders?
4. Should the nuclear power plant remain under Mr. Burns's control, be temporarily nationalized, or be permanently closed?
5. How should Springfield distribute electricity, transportation, medical supplies, food, and clean water?
6. What information should be released to the public, and how can the committee combat dangerous rumors?
7. Should Springfield accept assistance from Shelbyville, the state government, or outside corporations?
8. How should the committee investigate whether the explosion resulted from negligence, sabotage, or conspiracy?
9. How can Springfield hold responsible parties accountable without delaying the immediate emergency response?
10. What reforms are necessary to ensure that Springfield survives both the present crisis and future disasters?

Committee Objectives

The immediate goal of this committee is to prevent a complete nuclear meltdown and protect the population of Springfield. Delegates must coordinate technical operations at the plant, restore essential services, manage evacuation or shelter procedures, maintain public order, and provide accurate information to residents.

The committee must also investigate the cause of the explosion. Evidence may point toward corporate negligence, employee error, political corruption, deliberate sabotage, or several of these factors at once. Delegates should preserve evidence, question witnesses, and establish a credible process for determining responsibility.

Finally, delegates must decide what Springfield will become after the emergency. The disaster may require the restructuring of local government, the future of nuclear energy, relations with Shelbyville, environmental regulation, and ownership of the plant. A solution that contains the reactor but leaves Springfield politically or economically destroyed will not represent complete success.

KEY TERM: DIRECTIVE

Creative thinking is strongly encouraged. Because this committee is based upon The Simpsons, unusual inventions, exaggerated plans, and comedic developments may occur. Nevertheless, delegates' actions must use resources their characters could reasonably access. No character possesses unlimited money, knowledge, or authority.

Committee Powers

This committee runs on two channels: what the committee does openly, and what individual delegates do behind the scenes. Understanding the difference is the fastest way to be effective in round.

PUBLIC DIRECTIVE

A motion passed by the committee as a whole, voted on in the open room. Directives represent Springfield's official emergency response — evacuation orders, plant shutdowns, public statements, requests for outside aid. They require majority support and are the only actions that bind the whole town.

PRIVATE CRISIS NOTE

A note submitted individually or with a small group to the crisis staff, describing an action taken using a character's personal resources, relationships, or authority. Crisis notes are not voted on, and their results are not revealed to the room unless a delegate chooses to share them.

PORTFOLIO POWER

A resource or authority unique to a character — Mr. Burns's wealth, Chief Wiggum's officers, Krusty's media platforms. Portfolio powers make crisis notes more effective and should be named explicitly when used.

Writing an effective note or directive

Vague requests slow the committee down and produce vague results. A strong note or directive names who is acting, what resource or authority they are using, how the action will be carried out, and what outcome it is meant to achieve. "I use my police officers to secure the Kwik-E-Mart and prevent further looting" will be resolved faster and more favorably than "I stop the looting."

Crisis staff will respond to notes with updates — short written or verbal results describing what happened as a consequence of a delegate's action. Updates can create new opportunities, new obstacles, or both, and delegates should be ready to adjust their plans as updates arrive throughout the round.

Character List

Mayor Joe Quimby

The longtime mayor of Springfield and official leader of its emergency response. Charismatic but deeply corrupt, Quimby has survived numerous scandals through political connections and public charm. His office controls municipal agencies and emergency declarations, but evidence of his relationship with Mr. Burns could threaten his authority.

Charles Montgomery Burns

Owner of the Springfield Nuclear Power Plant and the wealthiest man in Springfield. His money, employees, private security, and political influence make him indispensable to the response — while the plant's safety failures place him at the center of the investigation. He seeks to retain ownership and prevent criminal liability.

Waylon Smithers

Mr. Burns's devoted executive assistant and the person most familiar with the plant's internal operations. He has access to company records, senior employees, security systems, and Burns's private resources. His knowledge could save Springfield — or conceal the truth forever.

Homer Simpson

The Nuclear Safety Inspector assigned to Sector 7-G, working when the explosion occurred. He lacks technical discipline but knows the plant's routines, hidden passages, and employees better than many executives. Whether he caused the accident, witnessed it, or was positioned to take the blame remains unknown.

Marge Simpson

A respected Springfield resident whose reliability contrasts sharply with many of the town's officials. She has strong relationships with neighborhood families, schools, churches, and local businesses, and can organize civilian relief — but places her family's safety above political convenience.

Lisa Simpson

An exceptionally intelligent student, environmental activist, and experienced voice in Springfield politics. She has studied nuclear power, public health, and government ethics, though adults frequently underestimate her because of her age. Her challenge is turning correct ideas into policies Springfield will actually accept.

Bart Simpson

A notorious prankster with unmatched knowledge of Springfield's back streets, tunnels, rooftops, and youth networks. He can move unnoticed, gather information, and disrupt plans. His loyalties are unpredictable, but threats to his family or town can motivate surprising courage.

Chief Clancy Wiggum

Leads the Springfield Police Department, controlling officers, vehicles, detention facilities, and criminal records — though his department is poorly trained and easily distracted. He must prevent looting, control traffic, protect critical locations, and investigate possible sabotage.

Kent Brockman

Springfield's most influential television journalist and the face of Channel 6 News. His broadcasts can calm the public, destroy reputations, or create mass panic. He possesses leaked documents allegedly proving years of misconduct at the plant.

Professor John Frink

Springfield's leading scientist and inventor. His laboratory contains experimental machines capable of radiation detection, remote operation, energy production, and unpredictable malfunction. His inventions often lack testing, and desperate officials may pressure him to deploy them early.

Seymour Skinner

Principal of Springfield Elementary, responsible for the hundreds of students sheltering inside it. His military experience gives him some knowledge of logistics and discipline, though his decisions remain vulnerable to interference from Superintendent Chalmers and Agnes Skinner.

Superintendent Gary Chalmers

Oversees Springfield's public schools and maintains contacts within the state education system, able to request buses, emergency funding, and facilities outside the town. He is deeply concerned with institutional liability.

Ned Flanders

A small-business owner, church volunteer, and one of Springfield's most dependable citizens. His supplies, home, store inventory, and volunteer network can support displaced families. His generosity makes him influential — and vulnerable to exploitation.

Reverend Timothy Lovejoy

Leads the First Church of Springfield, now a shelter and gathering point for frightened residents. He possesses community trust, volunteer networks, and the ability to shape the moral interpretation of the disaster.

Krusty the Clown

Springfield's most famous entertainer and owner of a vast commercial brand, controlling studios, advertising platforms, food supplies, delivery vehicles, and significant personal wealth. He could build a relief network — or treat the disaster as a publicity opportunity.

Sideshow Bob

Robert "Sideshow Bob" Terwilliger is an intelligent criminal mastermind with a history of attempted murder, election fraud, and political ambition. He may begin in custody, under supervision, or as a controversial consultant. He claims his knowledge of sabotage can identify the attacker.

Fat Tony

Leader of Springfield's organized-crime network, controlling smugglers, warehouses, construction contacts, and access to goods unavailable through legal channels. His organization can deliver vital supplies when official systems fail — but every favor creates a debt.

Dr. Julius Hibbert

A senior physician at Springfield General Hospital, directing medical triage, radiation screening, and emergency treatment with limited electricity and supplies. He needs accurate information from the plant to protect patients and staff.

Lenny Leonard

A longtime plant employee and informal representative of its workforce. He understands everyday conditions inside the facility and knows which employees witnessed earlier safety failures. He seeks to rescue trapped coworkers and protect their jobs.

Carl Carlson

A plant employee with greater technical judgment than many coworkers, knowledgeable about reactor operations and maintenance procedures. He can organize workers to stabilize the plant, but will not risk their lives merely to protect Burns's property.

Glossary

A short reference for delegates new to crisis committees.

Directive

A motion passed by the full committee, voted on in the open room. Represents Springfield's official response.

Crisis note

A private note describing an individual character's action, submitted to crisis staff and not read aloud to the room.

Portfolio power

A resource or authority unique to a character, such as Mr. Burns's wealth or Chief Wiggum's officers.

Update

The crisis staff's written or verbal response describing the outcome of a crisis note.

Joint personal directive

A crisis note submitted by two or more delegates acting together, combining their portfolio powers.

Moderated caucus

A structured speaking format in which the chair calls on delegates in turn to speak on a specific sub-topic.

Unmoderated caucus

An open period in which delegates leave their seats to negotiate, draft directives, or plan in small groups.

Backroom

The informal negotiations and alliances that happen outside of formal speeches and votes.

Front channel

Anything said or done in the open committee room, visible to every delegate.

Gavel

The chair's authority to recognize speakers, enforce time limits, and rule on points and motions.
